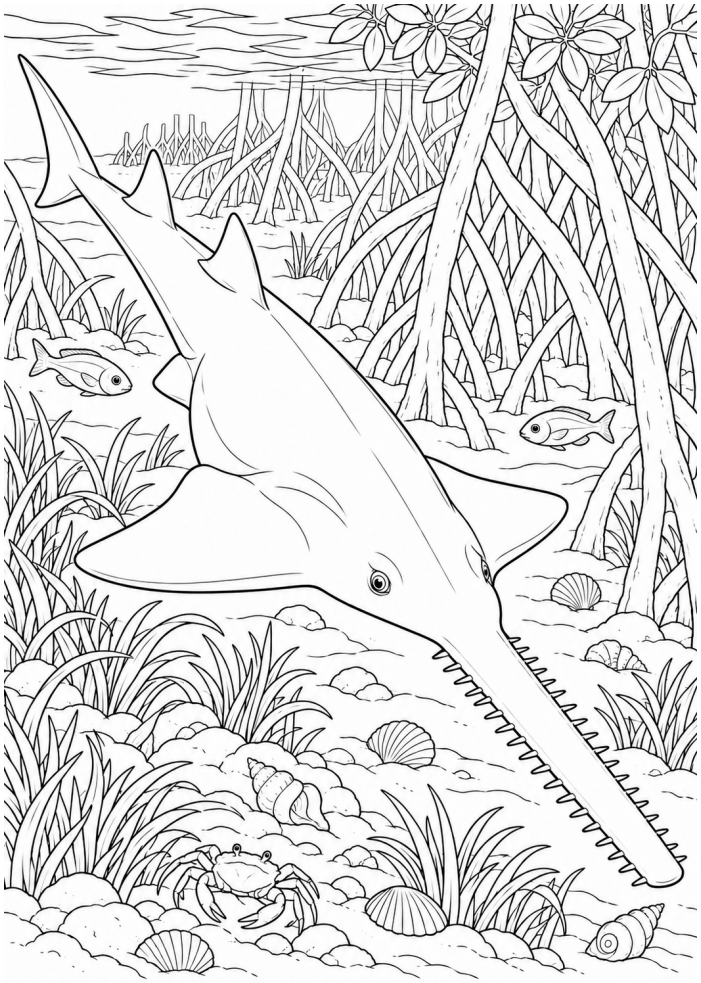
Smalltooth Sawfish

Pristis pectinata

More info



Where it lives



Dots: land White: sea

Examples: Florida and the Bahamas

RANGE AND HABITAT

Important remaining strongholds include **Florida and the Bahamas**. Pups use shallow estuaries and mangrove shores.

SIZE AND GROWTH

It can reach about **5 m**, including the saw. A newborn pup is about **70 cm** long.

A SENSING SAW

Sensory organs in its saw detect weak electrical fields from prey.

FOOD

It mainly eats **fish**, and sometimes shrimp. Its saw helps it find and catch prey.

BODY SHAPE

It is a **ray**. Its mouth and five pairs of gill slits are underneath. Its eyes are on top.

LIVE YOUNG

It gives birth to **live pups**. A soft sheath protects each pup's saw at birth and soon disappears.

SLOW RECOVERY

Maturity begins at about **7 years**. Females usually give birth every other year, so populations recover slowly.

NATURAL PREDATORS

Sharks, including **bull sharks**, can prey on young sawfish. Shallow mangrove waters provide shelter.

MAIN THREATS

Major threats include **accidental capture in fishing nets** and **loss of coastal habitat**.

PROTECTION

Globally **Critically Endangered (CR, IUCN)**. In the USA, it is listed as **Endangered under the ESA**.